

Michael Yao

michael.zt.yao@gmail.com · [LinkedIn profile](#)

Education	Yale University 2023 - <i>BA Economics and Mathematics</i> . 4.0/4.0 GPA. Final year. • <i>Awards</i>: Phi Beta Kappa (top 42 students in year), 3× Top in Course. • <i>Selected courses</i>: Environmental Economics, Climate Dynamics (PhD), Intermediate Machine Learning, Data Economics (CS, PhD), Mathematical Statistics.
Experience	Research Assistant for Prof. Pascual Restrepo February 2026 - • Studying the labour market impact of new technologies. Derived a new procedure to understand whether our LLM-generated measurements were reliable. Intern , New Zealand Treasury (Te Tai Ōhanga) June - August 2025 <i>Analytics and Insights Team</i> • Advised our social policy team on how long New Zealanders stay in poverty, and how they escape. • Analysed tax data (covering 5 million New Zealanders over 10 years) from the NZ IDI database in R. Research Assistant for Prof. John Geanakoplos June 2024 - May 2025 • Agent-based modelling of the US Social Security system. • Simulated the volatility of wages and salaries over time using ~50 years of US data (~60 million observations) to understand the effect of adjusting tax brackets. Research Assistant for Prof. Annie Harper June - December 2024 • Interviewed people experiencing homelessness about their experiences with debt and fintech apps.
Leadership and Service	Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) , <i>Site Coordinator</i> 2026 - Leading weekly volunteer shifts to file taxes for low-income local residents. In 2026, our student organization helped over 1,000 residents claim ~\$1.5 million in refunds. Yale Salus Populi Foundation (International development society) 2023 - 2025 Organized speaker events with leading environmental economists. Taught weekly sessions about international development to ~20 first-years. Yale Kendo Club (martial art), <i>President</i> 2024 - Liaising with Yale University Club Sports and other universities to organise practices and travel to tournaments around the US Northeast.
Skills	Statistical computing and machine learning Python (NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, TensorFlow, big data in Dask), R (tidyverse, econometrics packages), MATLAB. Can read Fortran and Stata. Other software MS Excel, GitHub, Anaconda (Python package management), HTML, CSS, L ^A T _E X.